Jordan Rivera

Principal Software Engineer, AI Platforms
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Summary

Software engineer and architect with 12 years of experience building distributed systems and, since 2021, internal AI platforms. Designed the LLM gateway and retrieval services used by 40+ product teams at a payments company. Comfortable owning architecture from whiteboard to production, and mentoring engineers along the way.

Skills

Languages: Python, Java, TypeScript, SQL, Bash
Cloud & Platform: AWS (EC2, EKS, Lambda, S3, SageMaker, Bedrock), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Helm
AI & Data: Large Language Models, Retrieval-Augmented Generation, Prompt Engineering, MLOps, MLflow, Vector Databases (pgvector), Apache Spark, Airflow
Architecture: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, REST APIs, gRPC, System Design, Reference Architectures
Practices: CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Observability (Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry), Agile, Architecture Reviews

Experience

Principal Software Engineer, AI Platform, Northlake Payments Mar 2021 – Present
Chicago, IL

- Designed and led delivery of an internal LLM gateway on AWS EKS that routes requests across multiple foundation model providers; adopted by 40+ product teams.
- Built a retrieval-augmented generation service with pgvector and Python that cut average support-ticket research time by 35%.
- Defined reference architectures and ran monthly architecture reviews for AI workloads, including model risk and data privacy controls aligned with PCI-DSS.
- Introduced MLflow-based model registry and CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions, reducing model deployment time from two weeks to two days.
- Mentored 8 engineers; two were promoted to senior engineer.

Senior Software Engineer, Northlake Payments Jun 2017 – Feb 2021
Chicago, IL

- Re-architected the transaction-scoring pipeline from a monolith into event-driven microservices on Kafka and Java Spring Boot, handling 9,000 events per second.
- Led migration of 60 services to Kubernetes with Terraform and Helm, cutting infrastructure cost by 22%.
- Partnered with data science to productionize fraud models on SageMaker with automated monitoring and drift alerts.

Software Engineer, Brightline Logistics Jul 2014 – May 2017
Evanston, IL

- Built REST APIs in Java and Python for shipment tracking used by 1,200 enterprise customers.
- Implemented Airflow pipelines feeding a Redshift data warehouse for operations reporting.
- Wrote integration and unit tests that raised coverage from 40% to 78%.

Projects

Open-source LLM evaluation harness — Python toolkit for regression-testing prompts and retrieval quality
- Maintains 1,100+ GitHub stars; used by teams to compare model versions before rollout.

Education

B.S. Computer Science | University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign | 2014

Certifications

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2022)
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) (2020)